

Blu-Ray Discs Being Shipped

TDK has started shipping cartridge-free Blu-ray discs, in both recordable and re-writable formats. Both versions are available in single-layer 25 GB and dual-layer 50 GB capacities. Costs range from \$20 to \$60 (Rs 960–2,880).



7900 On Your Laptop

NVIDIA stokes the fire for mobile gaming with the GeForce Go 7900 GTX and 7900 GS Mobile GPUs, which have already started shipping with Dell and Toshiba's gaming notebooks. These companies are the only ones shipping the GPUs now, but many will follow.



Enter

Sonali Kulkarni
Actress

A talented actress, Sonali Kulkarni has been a central figure in the theatre, having acted in plays such as *Sir, Sir, Sarla*, besides several films such as *Mission Kashmir* and *Dil Chahta Hai*. Here's a peek into the geek in her.

How would you define technology?

Technology is purely advancement. Every innovation in technology is a step mankind is taking towards development. It also acts as a stimulator—technological progress creates a qualitative difference in our lives.

What is tech to you?

With today's pace of life, even familiar technological gadgets like the TV or radio ease our stress. Technology is sometimes a double-edged sword. There's a desire to create the new, but at the same time, the "already there" becomes outdated.

Which of your gadgets are your favourites?

I just cannot make do without my cell phone—a Nokia 6600, and my Sony laptop. I have a host of other gadgets, like my DVD player, which I depend on without recognising their need.

Have you ever used technology for a specific purpose?

I've recently launched a Web site, and the forum here is open for people to discuss topics that interest them. I intend to use this space to do what I can with the renown that I receive through my profession.

SOURCE OF WOES

No 3D For Linux, Says FSF

The Free Software Foundation, the organisation that drafted the GPL (General Public License) that all open source software distributors need to follow, states that open source software cannot contain proprietary or closed source drivers. All well and good.

However, with the shift towards 3D Linux operating systems, which is intended mainly to combat Windows Vista's 3D interface, this directive of the GPL is becoming a pain in the neck, as it were.

Loads of open source flag bearers have criticised the inclusion and integration of various 3D Linux distros with drivers from NVIDIA and ATI. But considering that both ATI and NVIDIA refuse to provide open source drivers—which, by the way, is completely fine, because neither is an open source software company, and also that between the two of them, they hold all the market share worth mentioning in the 3D graphics hardware market—problems abound in 3D-Linux world.

"If Linux expects broader vendor support, the community needs to capitulate to proprietary software involvement," said Raven Zachary, an analyst at The 451 Group.

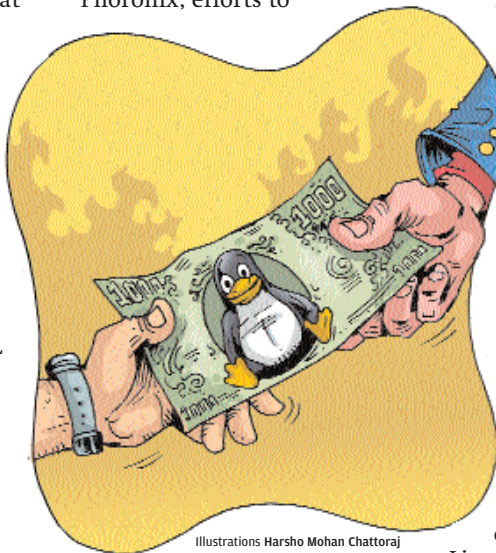
Writing open source graphics drivers without help from NVIDIA and ATI is tough. According to Michael Larabel, founder of high-end Linux hardware site Phoronix, efforts to

secondary issue. "It's so hard to write a graphics driver that open-sourcing it would not help," said Andrew Fear, NVIDIA's software product

manager. Some of NVIDIA's components are open, though, including some driver configuration tools and a driver component that interfaces to the kernel. "We believe in open source where it makes sense," Fear added.

Linux founder Linus Torvalds has argued that some proprietary modules are OK because they're not derived from the

Linux kernel, but were originally designed to work with other OSes. If they had originated from the kernel, that would require them to be covered by the GPL. The FSF doesn't quite agree. "If



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

reverse-engineer open source equivalents often are months behind and produce only "rudimentary" drivers. For NVIDIA, intellectual property is a

